

to prevent modification of original data is known as write-blocking device. The acquired image and original media are both hashed (using SHA-1 or MD5) and values are compared to verify the accuracy of the copy.

A challenge in searching evidence is to know where to look for it. For instance, some investigations may require examining the data stored in the hard disk drive; while in certain

cases of network intrusion, evidence may exist only in the RAM. Therefore there is no single procedure for collecting evidence.

The investigator must know which tool has to be used in order to make the evidence apparent. It is also important to identify and gather evidence without losing its integrity and value so that it is admissible in the court of law.



Fig. 2: A portable Tableau write-blocker attached to a hard drive (Image courtesy: Wikipedia)

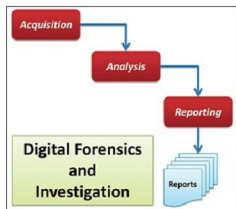


Fig. 3: Steps involved in a digital forensic investigation

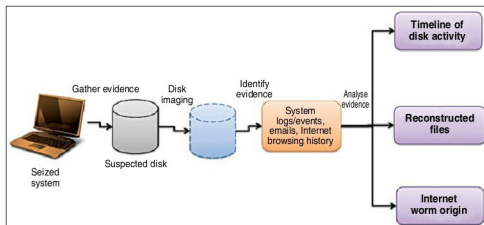


Fig. 4: A typical computer forensic investigation strategy

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